EquWord Quick Start for Mac

Gyeongcheol Cho

Document version 1.0.0

Software release 1.0.0

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Instruction basis

Microsoft Word 16.113.4 (16.113.26100421)

macOS 26.7.2 on Apple silicon

Repository github.com/PsycheMatrica/EquWord

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Use this guide with desktop Word for Mac to load EquWord, configure a manuscript, and practice conversion and equation layout. The Windows guide uses different installation menus.

Confirmation of the 1.0.0 Mac build is pending.

Load EquWord and prepare a document

1. Extract EquWord.zip in Finder. Keep the extracted folder in a stable location. The template is ResearchEquationFormatter.dotm; the practice document is in Tutorial.
2. Open desktop Microsoft Word. From the macOS menu bar, choose Tools > Templates and Add-ins.
3. Under Global templates and add-ins, choose Add, select ResearchEquationFormatter.dotm, and leave its checkbox selected. Unload an older EquWord template if one is already selected. Confirm the dialog.
4. Open Tutorial/REF_Practice.docx and use File > Save As to save a working copy under a different name. Keep the original practice file unchanged. Your working document can remain a .docx file.
5. Press Option+F8 to open Macros. On a keyboard that uses function keys for hardware controls, use Fn+Option+F8. Select AboutResearchEquationFormatter, choose Run, and confirm version 1.0.0.

Use macros only when permitted by your normal Word or organization policy. If Word blocks the template, use the normal approval process or ask your administrator. Keep security protections enabled.

Set up convenient commands

The Macros dialog is the basic way to run EquWord. Keep the manuscript window active, press Option+F8, choose the command, and select Run.

1. For optional buttons, open Word > Settings or Preferences > Ribbon & Toolbar. Microsoft uses Preferences in its Mac customization instructions; the label can vary by Word build.
2. Open the Quick Access Toolbar controls. If the command-source list offers Macros, select it, choose an EquWord macro, and use the add arrow. Save the change. Add only the commands you use frequently.
3. If your Word build does not offer those macros for toolbar customization, continue using Option+F8. Button availability does not affect the template loading procedure.
4. Run ConfigureCurrentDocument. Review the font and notation options, multiline layout, internal row spacing, number-table placement, and Follow current equation setting. Accept the choices for this manuscript.

For an APA-style manuscript, set the body style to Times New Roman 12 pt and double spacing. Equation paragraphs follow the body line spacing. With multiline merging, internal row spacing is separate; the new-profile default is 1.5 lines.

Convert text and format an equation

1. In Exercise 1 of the practice copy, select the complete source expression, including the opening and closing delimiters. Do not include the surrounding instructions.

$$y = x + 1$$

2. Open Macros with Option+F8. Run ConvertAndFormatLatexInSelection. Confirm the intended scope and settings when prompted.
3. Read the result and review-note dialogs. Click inside the result and confirm that it is an editable native Word equation showing y equals x plus one. Save the practice copy.
4. In Exercise 2, click inside the existing native equation. Run FormatEquationsInSelection. This command formats native equations without requiring LaTeX conversion.

For a separate conversion check, type the source below in a fresh working paragraph, select the complete source, and run the selection conversion command. The fraction and Greek alpha should remain editable.

$$v = \frac{1}{2} + \alpha$$

ConvertAndFormatAllLatex processes supported source throughout the main document body. Use it only when that whole-body scope is intended.

Merge rows or reformat selected categories

1. In Exercise 3, select both equation paragraphs in the left cell of the numbered table. Selecting only one equation requests single-equation processing.
2. Run ConfigureCurrentDocument and choose multiline merging with 1.5-line internal spacing. Then run FormatEquationsInSelection on the complete selected group.
3. Check for one editable two-row block aligned at the equals signs, with its original equation number. The outer equation paragraph should continue to follow the body spacing.
4. To change only layout, run SelectiveReformatInSelection. Choose Deselect all, select the relevant layout or line-spacing categories, and run. Select all restores all categories; accepted choices are remembered for the document.

FormatAllEquations formats native equations throughout the main body. SelectiveReformatAllEquations applies chosen categories throughout that scope. Use the selection commands when you want to work on one block.

Structure, equation-number field, and bookmark preservation checks always run. Review any skipped or retained structure in the result notes. A successful run does not replace visual review of the equation and surrounding text.

Review save and reload

1. Check the equations, adjacent prose, equation number, and reference text. On Mac, Option+F9 toggles field codes; use it again to return to displayed values. Fn may be needed with the function key.
2. Save the practice copy, close it, and reopen it. Click a native equation and rerun FormatEquationsInSelection to check ordinary repeat use.
3. After restarting Word, return to Tools > Templates and Add-ins. Reload the exact template if needed, then run AboutResearchEquationFormatter. Loading through this dialog is a session-based method; check it after each restart.

Mac review notes may appear in multiple dialogs. Read through them before saving. The recorded Mac implementation does not provide Windows-style automatic full-log saving or Esc polling. Keep a copy before each substantial run.

For the current release, citation details, and compatibility notes, use the repository. This guide covers the recorded Word for Mac environment; menu labels and availability can differ in other builds.

EquWord repository and citation information

Microsoft Support Keyboard shortcuts in Word

Microsoft Support Customize the ribbon in Office

Citing EquWord

If EquWord contributed to equation preparation in your manuscript, please consider citing the software in the Acknowledgments or another appropriate section. Cite the version you actually used.

Citation is optional when using EquWord.

Use only statements that reflect your actual use. Adjust the tools, tasks, software version, and singular or plural author wording as needed.

Example of software use

Equations were prepared in Microsoft Word using EquWord (Version 1.0.0; Cho, 2026).

Optional example involving ChatGPT

Use this combined example only if you also used ChatGPT for drafting and revision.

ChatGPT (OpenAI) assisted with drafting and revision. The authors reviewed the AI-assisted content and take responsibility for the final manuscript. Equations were prepared in Microsoft Word using EquWord (Version 1.0.0; Cho, 2026).

Reference

Cho, G. (2026). *EquWord: Equation conversion and formatting for Microsoft Word* (Version 1.0.0) [Computer software]. https://github.com/PsycheMatrica/EquWord

Use the released version's DOI when available.